

Razer Blade 18

The best of both worlds at a premium price

In the last couple of years, I've come across gaming laptops of all shapes and sizes. From the compact 14-inch devices to the 18-inch beasts, there's something for every kind of gamer out there. But for the last few days, I've been using the most compact 18-inch device that I've ever come across. And I have been quite impressed. The device that I'm talking about is the Razer Blade 18, powered by an Intel Core Ultra 9 chipset and an Nvidia 5090 GPU. The moment I unboxed the laptop, the first thing that I could say was 'This doesn't feel like an 18-inch gaming beast'. But, well, it is.

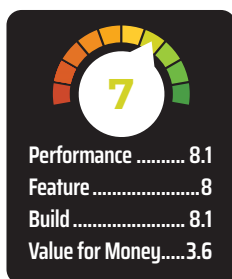
Before the Razer Blade, the other 18-inch gaming laptop that I used was the Dell 18 Area 51, a couple of months back. It had similar specs to the Razer Blade 18, but it also came with a heavy build and didn't even try to be backpack-friendly. Now, there isn't a lot of difference in the two devices in terms of weight on paper, but the Razer Blade 18 definitely feels easier to carry around.

DISPLAY

The display is easily one of the highlights of this device. The Razer Blade 18 comes with a large dual-mode panel that can switch between 4K at 240Hz and Full HD at 440Hz.

During my time with the device, I found myself sticking to the 4K mode most of the time. The 440Hz mode is for competitive gamers who want more frame rates, even if it comes at the cost of graphic quality. However, switching between these two modes is not as

₹4,75,000



seamless as it should be. You have to go into the software, change the settings, and restart the system. That makes it less practical for frequent switching, so most users will likely stick to one mode (just like I did).

At a glance, the display looks sharp, vibrant, and bright enough, making it great for both gaming and watching content indoors. Outdoors too, the display is bright enough to handle most of your tasks. But let's be honest here, how many gamers actually use their laptops outdoors? (Hint: Not a lot of them)

Coming to the colours, they are well balanced, and the overall viewing experience feels justified for the price. The panel also covers a wide colour gamut, which shows how accurate the colours are. During my testing, I found that the laptop covers the sRGB as well as the DCI P3 colour spaces quite well.

PERFORMANCE

Let's now come to the aspect that mat-

ters the most in any device: performance. And the Razer Blade 18, powered by the Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX, delivers exactly what you would expect from a flagship HX-series chip. On paper, the chipset brings a mix of performance and efficiency cores, along with an upgraded NPU and better thread scheduling.

In practice, the laptop is able to juggle heavy workloads without slowing down as the machine can prioritise demanding tasks while keeping background processes in check. I was not only able to run modern AAA games easily, but also multitask without any noticeable dips in performance.

On a busy Monday morning, I did what most gamers would do to beat those morning blues – I fired up Resident Evil Requiem. But soon after, an email needed my attention, and I easily answered it, keeping the game

running in the background. Then, I started working on an article that had to go live urgently, completely forgetting that the game was still running in the background. So, the laptop can multitask without breaking a sweat.

This is because the chipset intelligently distributes workloads between performance and efficiency cores, ensuring that background tasks do not eat into foreground performance. Hence, even with a heavy AAA title like Resident Evil Requiem running, the laptop remained responsive with no slowdowns while switching between tasks.

Another thing I noticed during extended use is how stable the performance remains over time. With gaming laptops that try to balance performance with a relatively slim chassis, you often see fluctuations once thermals kick in. But here, the drop-off is far less noticeable. The chip is able to sustain its performance for longer durations, which makes a huge difference during those long gaming sessions or work hours.

Coming to gaming specifically, I tested out many titles ranging from